

|By Damayanti Datta|

Sometimes it takes Dr Prathap C. Reddy two hours to get to his car. Apollo Hospital, Chennai, is not that large. But between his office and the parking lot he gets buttonholed by hundreds—people with loved ones fighting for life somewhere in his hospital. They entreat him to find out why the doctors are huddling together in hushed whispers; they complain about the food; they sigh over the bills; they grumble, they gripe and they appeal for help from the man who set up the Apollo Group. From his 25 years of experience, Reddy knows the significance of that moment: “When they leave, they’ll remember just one thing: did my hospital care for me?”

How many of our hospitals would fulfil that very human need to feel cared for when we are at our most vulnerable? Check out the writing on the wall. And that, too, from those who are usually at the receiving end—patients. A survey commissioned by the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Government of India, has brought out what patients value the most when living under neon lights and in the shadow of disease. Conducted by the consumer body, VOICE (Voluntary Organisation

in the Interest of Consumer Education) on 4,000 patients in six metros, it is reportedly one of the first-ever surveys to tally patient satisfaction with quality of hospital service in India—a country not known for bestowing power to the patient. “The view of the patient as a consumer is the need of the hour,” says Bijon Mishra of VOICE, who mentored the project. “Although the healthcare market is booming—from Rs 927 billion in 2001 it’s slated to touch Rs 2,088 billion by 2012—

Honourroll TOP5

Overall satisfaction

1. Escorts Heart Institute & Research Centre, Delhi
2. Care Banjara, Hyderabad
3. Apollo Hospital, Chennai
4. Manipal Hospital, Bangalore
5. Wockhardt Superspeciality, Cunningham Road, Bangalore

Word of mouth leaders

1. Manipal Hospital, Bangalore
2. Indraprastha Apollo, Delhi
3. Escorts Heart Institute, Delhi
4. All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Delhi
5. Peerless Hospital and BK Roy Research Centre, Kolkata

Most chosen for
**Good
image**

1. Escorts Heart Institute, Delhi
2. Batra Hospital, Delhi
3. Sir Gangaram Hospital, Delhi
4. Max Superspeciality, Delhi
5. Indraprastha Apollo, Delhi

Report on Study of Client Satisfaction with Quality of Hospital Services, 2008

**Khane mein
kya hai?**



CHOLESTEROL-FREE | NO HYDROGENATED FATS

NO TRANS FATS | LOW IN SATURATED FATS

RICH IN MUFA & PUFA | VITAMIN A, D & E